

BD CRM: Requirements and Data Model

Scoping document, draft vo.1

1. PURPOSE AND SCOPE

The BD team currently runs its pipeline, strategic initiatives and revenue forecast out of a set of Excel workbooks. Those workbooks hold genuinely useful content: named prospects, expected revenue, probability weightings, owners, stage, next actions, blockers and initiative-level targets. What they do not have is structure. There is no unique identifier on any record, no controlled vocabulary on any field, no clean date anywhere, and the same opportunity is restated across three sheets at three different levels of granularity.

This document sets out what the CRM needs to be: the entities it must hold, the fields on each, the controlled lists those fields draw from, how a lead becomes an opportunity, how the forecast and budget are derived rather than typed, and what has to happen to the existing data before it can be loaded.

In scope

Lead capture and qualification, opportunity pipeline management, strategic initiative tracking, revenue forecasting with probability weighting, target and budget management by unit and owner, and management reporting.

Out of scope for now

Policy administration, claims, premium collection, commission accounting and client servicing. The CRM stops at the point an opportunity is won and handed to operations. It should carry a reference to the resulting account, not replicate it.

This boundary is under review. The CEO Summit pack reports revenue in three lines, New Business, Retention and Policy Fees, of which New Business is roughly a fifth of the full-year budget. If the CRM is expected to produce that pack rather than only the pipeline within it, retention and policy fee revenue come back into scope along with actuals and a phased budget. See section 15 and question 11.

2. WHAT THE CURRENT WORKBOOKS CONTAIN

Both open workbooks, BD RAW DATA.xlsx and BD RAW DATA_3.xlsx, hold the same three sheets, which are in substance three views of the same pipeline at three levels of aggregation. The table below describes those three sheets. All amounts are in UGX and all records are Uganda-based, although neither fact is recorded in a column anywhere, and neither workbook contains a single Excel Table, so every sheet is a plain range with no structured reference to rely on.

Sheet	What it holds	Size	Main problem
Amended Forecast	Opportunity-level pipeline and revenue forecast. One row per opportunity, product and effective month, with expected revenue, probability, weighted revenue, owner, stage, next action, blocker and CEO support required.	224 data rows, 19 columns	No opportunity ID. Stage and outcome are mixed in one field. Fourteen blank separator rows sit inside the data. The initiative link is a hard cell reference, not a lookup.
Strategic Business Initiative	Initiative register. 2026 revenue target, revenue delivered to 31 August, September to December monthly expectations, gap to target, champion, next milestone and evidence notes.	156 rows, 23 columns	Five different table blocks stacked on one sheet. UNIT is spelled four ways. One revenue column has no header at all.

Sheet	What it holds	Size	Main problem
Sheet1 Mapped (Amended) (2)	Reconciliation view mapping initiatives to forecast opportunities, plus a summary by initiative and a flag for revenue already captured in the forecast.	88 detail rows plus a summary block, 23 columns	Merged cells in the UNIT and Initiative columns. A TOTAL row sits inside the data. A second header row appears mid-sheet.

Two divergent versions of the same file

The two workbooks are not a dataset and a supplement. They are the same dataset in two versions that have drifted apart, and nothing inside either file says which is current. The forecast sheet and the mapped sheet are identical in both. The initiative register is not: BD RAW DATA.xlsx carries 172 rows against 157 in BD RAW DATA_3.xlsx, and the revenue column that has a proper header in the first workbook has lost that header in the second, which is how it became the unlabelled column noted above.

More seriously, BD RAW DATA.xlsx already contains #REF! errors in the Strategic Initiative Link column. The fragility described in section 3 is not a future risk. It has already happened in a live copy of the file, and the link that broke is the one that ties an opportunity to its initiative.

This is the argument for the CRM in its shortest form. Two people working on the same pipeline produced two files that no longer agree, and there is no mechanism inside Excel to tell anyone which one to trust. Whichever platform is chosen, single-record ownership with an audit trail is the requirement that matters most, ahead of any reporting feature.

Sheet	BD RAW DATA.xlsx	BD RAW DATA_3.xlsx
Amended Forecast	A1:S520, 19 columns. #REF! errors present in Strategic Initiative Link.	A1:S520, 19 columns. Hard cell links intact but pointing at fixed cells.
Strategic Business Initiative	172 rows, 23 columns. Column U correctly headed Revenue Already Captured in Amended Forecast.	157 rows, 23 columns. Column U header lost, leaving an unlabelled revenue column.
Sheet1 Mapped (Amended) (2)	A1:W101, 23 columns.	A1:W101, 23 columns. Identical.

3. DATA QUALITY FINDINGS

These are the specific problems in the current data. Each one is a requirement in disguise: the CRM has to make the problem impossible rather than merely tidy it up once.

Finding	Evidence in the workbooks	What the CRM must do
No unique identifiers	No opportunity ID or client ID exists anywhere. The only join key between sheets is free-text client name, which varies by trailing space and abbreviation.	Generate a system ID on every record. Client name must never be a key.
Stage and outcome in one field	Opportunity Stage holds 12 values mixing pipeline position (Prospecting, Engaged, Quotation, Proposal Submitted, Tender or RFP, Shortlisted) with final outcome (Awarded, Closed, Lost, On Hold), plus a lowercase duplicate of Closed.	Split into Stage and Outcome. Win rate cannot be calculated until these are separate.
No clean dates	Every date-like column mixes Excel serials, month names, bare years, quarters, TBA, TBD, N/A and full sentences. One value reads 31/11/2026, which is not a real date.	True date fields only, with a separate date-to-be-confirmed flag instead of text placeholders.
Uncontrolled picklists	Product has 24 distinct values including Medical, MED and Med, and life, Life, Motor and MOTOR. Dept,	Every categorical field becomes a managed dropdown. Around a third of current distinct values are duplicates.

Finding	Evidence in the workbooks	What the CRM must do
	Initiative and Status all carry case and spacing variants. UNIT is spelled four ways.	
Multiple owners in one cell	Owner values include Evelyn/Ashley, Helen/Evelyn/Edgar and Moses Ssewajja / Benjamin Mukasa alongside single first names, giving 16 apparent owners for 6 real people.	Owner links to a user record, with a separate co-owner relationship. Individual targets and attribution are impossible otherwise.
Aggregates inside the data	A TOTAL row sits inside the detail block on the mapped sheet. Sep to Dec Expected is a formula on some rows and hardcoded on others.	Totals live only in the reporting layer. Derived figures are always calculated, never typed.
Fragile cross-sheet links	The forecast sheet's initiative link is a set of point-to-point cell references. Inserting or sorting a row on the initiative sheet silently repoints them.	Initiative becomes a real relationship, not a cell address.
Three-way duplication	The same opportunity is restated on all three sheets at different granularity and with different spellings. The mapped sheet exists only to reconcile the other two.	One record in one place. The reconciliation sheet disappears once the model is relational.
Errors and residue	One #VALUE! in the weighted revenue column, caused by a text space in Expected Revenue. Rows 226 to 520 are empty but inside the used range. 65 rows are frozen.	Validation rejects non-numeric revenue at the point of entry.
Links already broken	#REF! errors are present in the Strategic Initiative Link column of BD RAW DATA.xlsx. The point-to-point cell references have already failed in a live copy of the file.	Initiative is a system-enforced relationship, so a link cannot break silently and cannot be broken by sorting a sheet.
No version control	Two workbooks hold the same three sheets with divergent row counts, a lost column header and no marker of which is current. Neither file defines a single Excel Table, so nothing is a structured range.	One record, one owner, one audit trail. Saved copies of a spreadsheet are not record history.

4. TARGET DATA MODEL

The core design decision is to separate the thing being pursued from its revenue phasing. Today the forecast sheet carries one row per opportunity, product and month, which is why the same client appears four or six times with no way to tell whether that is one deal phased across months or several distinct deals. In the target model an opportunity is one pursuit, and its revenue is a set of dated schedule lines underneath it.

Entity	Purpose	Grain (one row per...)
Account	Clients and prospects. Holds sector, unit, country and the relationship history.	Organisation
Contact	Named people at an account, with role and whether they are a decision maker.	Person
Lead	Unqualified interest, from any source, before it is worth forecasting.	Enquiry or approach
Opportunity	A qualified pursuit with an owner, a stage, a probability and an expected close date.	Pursuit
Revenue Schedule Line	The money. Product, effective month, expected amount and the weighted amount derived from it.	Opportunity, product and month

Entity	Purpose	Grain (one row per...)
Strategic Initiative	The initiative register: annual target, champion, unit, sector, status and next milestone.	Initiative
Activity	Meetings, calls, submissions and the next action with its due date.	Interaction or task
User and Team	BD staff, their unit, department and reporting line.	Person
Target	Revenue targets by year, unit, owner, initiative and product.	Target assignment
Budget Line	BD cost budget and actual spend against it.	Cost line and period
Reference List	The managed picklists: stages, outcomes, products, departments, units, sectors and lead sources.	List value

Twelve entities at this point. Account, Opportunity, Revenue Schedule Line and Strategic Initiative carry the bulk of the content currently held in the spreadsheets. Two more are added later in this document: Tender in section 15 and Stage History in section 16, bringing the model to fourteen.

Relationships that matter

An account has many opportunities. An opportunity has many revenue schedule lines, which is what replaces the repeated client rows in the forecast sheet. An opportunity may be linked to one strategic initiative, and an initiative rolls up many opportunities, which is what replaces the hard cell links and the multi-client text blob. An opportunity has one owner and optionally several co-owners, which is what replaces Helen/Evelyn/Edgar in a single cell.

5. FIELD SPECIFICATION, CORE ENTITIES

5.1 Lead

Nothing in the current workbooks captures a lead. The forecast sheet starts at Prospecting, which means every approach that never reached a forecastable stage is invisible, and there is no way to measure how much top-of-funnel activity it takes to generate a pursuit. This is a new entity.

Field	Type	Notes and validation
Lead ID	Auto number	System generated, never edited.
Company name	Text, required	Checked against existing accounts on entry to catch duplicates.
Contact name, email, phone	Text	At least one contact method required before the lead can be qualified.
Lead source	Picklist, required	Referral, tender notice, bancassurance partner, cross-sell, event, inbound, outbound, existing client. Needed to measure which channels actually convert.
Sector	Picklist	Shared list with Account and Initiative.
Unit and department	Picklist, required	Determines routing and whose funnel it lands in.
Product of interest	Picklist, multi-select	Same managed product list as the revenue schedule.
Estimated value	Currency	Rough order of magnitude only. Not part of the forecast.
Owner	User link, required	Single named person. Unassigned leads are the ones that die.
Status	Picklist, required	New, contacted, qualifying, qualified, disqualified, dormant.
Disqualification reason	Picklist	Required when status is disqualified. Feeds the reasons we lose before we even bid.
Created date and age	Date, auto	Age is derived. Drives the ageing and neglect reports.
Converted opportunity	Opportunity link, read-only	Populated automatically on conversion. Preserves the funnel audit trail.

5.2 Opportunity

This replaces the Amended Forecast sheet, minus the money, which moves to the revenue schedule. Two changes are structural rather than cosmetic: stage is separated from outcome, and probability is driven by stage rather than typed per row.

Field	Type	Notes and validation
Opportunity ID	Auto number	The identifier the current data has no equivalent of.
Account	Account link, required	Replaces free-text Prospective Client Name.
Opportunity name	Text, required	Convention: account, product family, year. Distinguishes the four Memnon Capital rows from each other.
Unit, department, sector	Picklist, required	Managed lists. Resolves UNIT 1 against UNIT 1 and EBM against EBM with a trailing space.
Owner	User link, required	One accountable person.
Co-owners	User link, multi-select	Replaces Evelyn/Ashley and Helen/Evelyn/Edgar in a single cell.
Stage	Picklist, required	Pipeline position only. See section 6 for the definitive list.
Outcome	Picklist, required	Open, won, lost, on hold, withdrawn. Separated from stage so win rate is calculable.
Probability	Percent, defaulted by stage	Defaults from the stage mapping in section 7. Override allowed but must be justified in a note.
Expected close date	Date, required	A true date. No TBA, no month names, no bare years.
Close date confidence	Picklist	Confirmed, estimated, to be confirmed. This is where TBA belongs, not in the date field.
Strategic initiative	Initiative link	A real relationship. Replaces the point-to-point cell references.
Forecast category	Picklist	Prior forecast or additional forecast. Preserves the existing Status distinction.
Next action and due date	Text and date, required while open	An open opportunity with no next action should surface as an exception.
Key blocker or risk	Text	Blank means no blocker. NIL, None and N/A are retired as values.
Management support required	Text plus a yes or no flag	The flag drives the CEO support report. The text explains what is needed.
Loss or hold reason	Picklist plus text	Required when outcome is lost or on hold. The current data records the loss but never the reason.
Source lead	Lead link, read only	Set on conversion.
Created date, last updated, days in stage	Auto	Last updated is a system timestamp, not a field someone remembers to type. In the current sheet 182 of 187 rows carry the same manually entered date.

5.3 Revenue schedule line

This is where the money lives, and it is the single biggest change from the current sheets. One opportunity can have many lines: one per product, one per effective month, or both. Credit Life appearing as a monthly row for four months becomes one opportunity with four schedule lines rather than four indistinguishable rows.

Field	Type	Notes and validation
Line ID	Auto number	System generated.
Opportunity	Opportunity link, required	The parent pursuit.
Product	Picklist, required	Managed list. Collapses the current 24 values to roughly 16 real products.
Effective month	Month and year, required	A true period value, not the text September. Drives all phasing.
Expected amount	Currency, required, must be numeric	Validation must reject a text space. That single bad cell is what produces the #VALUE! today.
Currency	Picklist, defaults to UGX	Every current amount is UGX but nothing records it. Add the field now rather than during a later regional rollout.
Probability	Percent, inherited	Inherited from the parent opportunity. Overridable per line only if a genuine case exists.
Weighted amount	Currency, derived	Expected amount multiplied by probability. Calculated, never entered. This is the existing formula, made structural.
Revenue type	Picklist	New business, renewal, cross-sell or upsell. The current data cannot distinguish these, so genuine growth cannot be separated from retained revenue.
Recurring	Yes or no	Flags whether the line repeats annually. Business here is mostly one-off, so the more important case is an opportunity that is not won this year and reappears the next. That is handled by carrying the pursuit forward rather than by a renewal type.

5.4 Strategic initiative

This replaces the initiative register. The critical difference is that revenue delivered, monthly expectations and gap to target stop being typed columns and become rollups from the opportunities linked to the initiative. The Sheet1 Mapped reconciliation sheet then has no reason to exist.

Field	Type	Notes and validation
Initiative ID and name	Auto number and text	Managed name. Resolves Oil & Gas against OIL & GAS and NGO Forum against NGO FORUM.
Unit and sector	Picklist, required	Sector is currently blank for every Unit 1 row and most Unit 3 rows. It becomes mandatory.
Champion	User link, required	A user record, not a first name.
Annual revenue target	Currency, required	The one figure that is legitimately entered rather than derived.
Revenue delivered	Currency, derived	Rollup of won opportunities against the initiative, to any chosen date.

Field	Type	Notes and validation
Expected by period	Currency, derived	Rollup of weighted schedule lines by month. Replaces the Sep, Oct, Nov and Dec typed columns.
Gap to target	Currency, derived	Target less delivered less expected. Never typed.
Status	Picklist, required	Not started, active, delayed, on hold, closed. Replaces the ten free-text variants currently in use.
Next milestone and date	Text and date	The date is a real date. Quarters and sentences move into the milestone text.
Linked opportunities	Relationship, derived	Replaces the text blob listing up to nine clients in one cell.
Evidence and comments	Long text with history	Append-only notes with author and timestamp, rather than a cell that concatenates three sources.

6. PIPELINE STAGES AND CONVERSION

The stage list below is built from the values already in use, deduplicated and put in order, with the outcome values pulled out. Each stage has an exit criterion so that stage movement means the same thing across all six owners. Without exit criteria a stage field is just an opinion.

Stage	What it means	Exit criterion	Default probability
Prospecting	Target identified, no substantive contact yet.	A named contact has responded.	10%
Information gathering	Contact established, gathering underwriting or risk information.	Enough information held to price or scope.	20%
Engaged	Active two-way discussion, need confirmed, budget indicated.	Client has invited a quotation, proposal or bid.	35%
Quotation prepared	Pricing built and internally approved, not yet with the client.	Quotation issued to the client.	50%
Proposal or tender submitted	Formal submission with the client or the procurement process.	Client confirms receipt and evaluation is underway.	70%
Shortlisted or final negotiation	Down to a short list, or negotiating final terms.	Award decision communicated.	85%

Outcome is a separate field with five values: open, won, lost, on hold and withdrawn. An opportunity keeps its last stage when it closes, so it is possible to see at which stage deals are lost. That is currently impossible, and it matters, because 39 of the 187 rows in the forecast are already marked Lost with no recorded reason and no recorded stage of loss.

Lead to opportunity conversion

A lead becomes an opportunity when four things are true: the account is identified and resolved against the existing account list, a decision-making contact is named, a product and an indicative value are known, and an owner has accepted it. Anything short of that stays a lead. On conversion the system creates the account if it does not exist, creates the opportunity at Prospecting or Information gathering, links back to the originating lead, and closes the lead as converted rather than deleting it.

Keeping the lead record is what makes conversion rate measurable. The question of how many approaches it takes to produce one pursuit, and which sources produce the pursuits that actually close, cannot be answered from the current data at all.

Rules the system should enforce

An open opportunity must have a next action and a due date. An opportunity cannot move past Quotation prepared without at least one revenue schedule line. Outcome cannot be set to lost or on hold without a reason. Probability cannot be edited away from the stage default without a note. Any opportunity untouched for 30 days appears on an ageing exception report. None of these are reports after the fact, they are conditions at the point of saving.

7. FORECASTING AND WEIGHTED PIPELINE

The existing weighted revenue formula, expected amount multiplied by probability, is the right calculation and should be kept. What it needs is a stable probability source, a clean date to phase against, and a record of what the forecast said last month. All three are missing today.

Forecast view	Definition	What it answers
Closed and won	Sum of schedule lines on opportunities with outcome won.	What we have actually delivered.
Committed	Won, plus open opportunities at or above the committed threshold, set to 50% to match current practice.	What we are prepared to promise.
Weighted pipeline	Sum of expected amount multiplied by probability across all open lines.	The realistic forecast. This is the existing calculation, phased by month.
Best case	Sum of expected amount, unweighted, across all open lines.	The ceiling if everything lands.
Gap to target	Target less won less weighted pipeline, by unit, owner and initiative.	Where intervention is needed and how much of it.
Coverage ratio	Open pipeline divided by remaining target.	Whether there is enough in the funnel at all. Below roughly three times, the target is not reachable on current win rates.

Monthly snapshots

The forecast must be snapshotted at each month end and stored, not overwritten. The Prior Forecast and Additional Forecast values in the current Status column are a manual attempt to do exactly this, and it only works once. With snapshots the movement between two months can be decomposed into new opportunities added, amounts revised, probability changes, deals won, deals lost and deals slipped to a later month. That decomposition is the most useful single report a BD forecast can produce and it is not obtainable from the workbooks as they stand.

Phasing

Revenue is phased by the effective month on each schedule line, so a monthly, quarterly or annual view is a grouping rather than a set of separate columns. The Sep, Oct, Nov and Dec columns on the initiative sheet become redundant, along with the Sep to Dec subtotal and the hardcoded rows that subtotal was meant to cover.

8. TARGETS AND BUDGETING

Two different things are called budgeting here and they need separating. The first is revenue targets, which the current workbooks hold at initiative level only. The second is BD cost budget, which they do not hold at all.

8.1 Revenue targets

Targets should be set at the level they are managed and roll up without adjustment. The hierarchy is company, then unit, then department, then strategic initiative, then individual owner, with an optional product split. The

system should refuse to save a set of unit targets whose sum does not reconcile to the company target, and should show the unallocated remainder while it is being built.

The current register holds a 2026 revenue target and revenue delivered to 31 August per initiative. Delivered becomes a rollup rather than a typed figure. What is missing is any target at owner level, which means the individual performance question cannot be answered even though owner is recorded on every opportunity.

8.2 BD cost budget

If the CRM is to help with budgeting rather than just forecasting, it needs the cost side. A budget line should carry the cost category, the owning unit, the period, the budgeted amount and the actual spend, with an optional link to the opportunity or initiative that the spend was for.

Cost category	Typical content	Why it links to pipeline
Client engagement and travel	Visits, meetings, hospitality.	Cost of pursuit, per opportunity where material.
Tender and bid costs	Bid bonds, documentation fees, technical support.	Directly attributable to a named opportunity. Gives cost per bid and cost per win.
Events and forums	The HR Forum, NGO Forum, Motivation Hub and similar initiative activity.	Attributable to a strategic initiative, so initiative return on spend becomes measurable.
Marketing and collateral	Campaigns, materials, digital.	Attributable to lead source, which is why the lead source field matters.
Partner and channel costs	Bancassurance partner support and enablement.	Attributable to the partner initiative, for example the UBA bancassurance block.
People and incentive	Commission, bonus, incentive accruals.	Modelled against won revenue by owner.

With both sides in one system the derived measures become available: cost per win, cost per acquired shilling of revenue, return on initiative spend, and budget consumed against pipeline generated. None of these can be produced today.

9. REPORTING

Every report below is a grouping of the same underlying records. The current practice of building a separate reconciliation sheet to answer a reporting question is what the model is designed to eliminate.

Report	Audience	Content
Pipeline by stage	BD team, weekly	Count and value by stage, by owner and by unit, with movement since last week.
Weighted forecast by month	Management, monthly	Weighted pipeline phased by effective month against target, with the gap.
Forecast movement	Management, monthly	Decomposition of the change since last snapshot into added, revised, won, lost and slipped.
Initiative scorecard	Management, monthly	Per initiative: target, delivered, weighted expected, gap, status and next milestone. Replaces the initiative sheet and the mapped sheet together.
Owner performance	Unit heads, monthly	Target against won and weighted, win rate, average deal size, average days to close, per owner.
Win and loss analysis	BD leadership, quarterly	Win rate by product, sector, unit and lead source, with loss reasons and the stage at which deals were lost.

Report	Audience	Content
Funnel conversion	BD leadership, quarterly	Lead to opportunity to win conversion rates by source. Not answerable from the current data at all.
Management support register	CEO and management	Open opportunities flagged as needing management support, with the ask and the value at stake.
Ageing and hygiene exceptions	BD team, weekly	Opportunities with no next action, overdue next actions, no movement in 30 days, close date in the past, or missing schedule lines.

10. MIGRATING THE EXISTING DATA

The current data is worth migrating, but not as it stands. The sequence below is deliberately ordered so that the cleanup decisions are made once, by the team, rather than repeatedly and inconsistently by whoever is loading the file.

Step	Task	Detail
1	Agree the controlled lists	Sign off the final values for unit, department, sector, product, stage, outcome, initiative, lead source and loss reason. This is the single highest-value hour of the project. Product alone goes from 24 values to roughly 16.
2	Build the user list	Map the 16 owner strings to six real people, decide who owns each multi-owner record, and record the rest as co-owners.
3	De-duplicate accounts	Resolve client names into a single account list, deciding which trailing-space and abbreviation variants are the same organisation.
4	Rebuild the opportunity grain	Group the 224 forecast rows into distinct pursuits and assign an opportunity ID, then convert each original row into a schedule line under its parent. Repeated clients such as the four Memnon Capital rows and the monthly Credit Life rows must be judged individually.
5	Fix the dates	Convert every serial to a date, resolve month names against a year, and reclassify TBA, TBD and N/A into the close date confidence field. Correct the impossible 31/11/2026.
6	Split stage and outcome	Map each current stage value to a stage plus an outcome, and capture a loss reason for the 39 lost rows while the context is still remembered.
7	Load initiatives and link	Load the initiative register, then replace the hard cell links and the multi-client text blobs with real relationships.
8	Reconcile and sign off	Total the loaded weighted pipeline against the current sheet total and explain every variance before going live. Retire the mapped reconciliation sheet at this point.

A realistic estimate is that steps one and two take a workshop, steps three to six take the bulk of the effort, and step four is the one that needs BD judgement rather than data work. Nobody outside the team can decide whether four Memnon Capital rows are one deal or four.

11. PLATFORM OPTIONS

The decision has been taken to build a custom web application. The data model above is platform-neutral and holds regardless, so nothing in sections 4 to 9 changes. What changes is that every behaviour described in those sections becomes something to be built and tested rather than configured, including the ones a commercial CRM would have given for nothing. The options below are recorded for completeness and to make the trade-off being accepted explicit.

Option	Fit	Trade-off
Structured Excel or Sheets, properly built	Lowest friction. Separate tables for accounts, opportunities and schedule lines, data validation on every list, no merged cells, no totals in the data, pivots and Power Query for reporting.	Snapshots and audit history are awkward. Concurrent editing by six people remains a risk. Discipline has to be human rather than enforced.

Option	Fit	Trade-off
No-code database, for example Airtable, Notion or Monday	Good fit for this model. Real relationships, enforced picklists, per-user views, forms for lead capture, quick to stand up.	Reporting is weaker than a real BI layer and costs scale per user. Complex rollup logic can become fragile.
Commercial CRM, for example Zoho, HubSpot or Dynamics	Everything here is native: leads, conversion, stages with probability, forecast categories, snapshots and dashboards.	Configuration effort and licence cost. The revenue schedule grain and the initiative rollup need deliberate design rather than default settings.
Custom build	Chosen. Total control over the initiative rollup, the revenue schedule grain and the budget side, and no licence cost per user.	Highest cost and the only option that creates a maintenance obligation. Hard to justify unless something here is genuinely unusual.

On the evidence of the current workbooks, the constraint is not tooling capability but data discipline, and a custom build has to supply that discipline deliberately because it inherits none of it. Three things in this document are cheap in a commercial CRM and are the usual places a custom build runs out of budget: the monthly forecast snapshot and the movement report derived from it, the field-level audit trail that answers who changed a probability and when, and role-based visibility so an owner sees their pipeline and a unit head sees the unit. These are not enhancements to be added in a later phase. They are the reason the spreadsheets failed, and a custom build that ships without them will fail the same way with a better interface.

12. ASSUMPTIONS AND OPEN QUESTIONS

The following are assumptions made in drafting this. Each one should be confirmed or corrected, and several will change the model rather than just the detail.

Area	Assumption made	Needs confirming
Business	Minet Uganda insurance broking, single country, all amounts UGX.	Whether other territories will use the same system, which decides whether currency and country are needed from day one.
Team	Six BD owners across three units and five departments, plus initiative champions.	Actual headcount, whether owners carry individual targets, and who outside BD needs read access.
Stages	The six stages and default probabilities in section 6.	Whether these match how the team actually works, particularly around tender processes.
Revenue basis	Amounts are brokerage commission rather than gross written premium.	Which basis the forecast is on. If it is premium, a commission rate field is needed and every figure changes meaning.
Recurrence rather than renewal	Opportunities are mostly one-off. An opportunity not won this year can reappear the following year rather than being permanently lost.	Confirmed in principle. What still needs deciding is how long a lost opportunity stays eligible to be revived, and whether a revived pursuit is a new record or a reopened one.
Budget	Budgeting means both revenue targets and BD cost budget.	Whether cost budget is in scope for phase one or whether revenue targets alone are enough to start.
Period	Financial year runs to December, given the 2026 target and September to December phasing.	The actual financial year end.
Authoritative version	Both workbooks have now been profiled and they disagree. The initiative register holds 172 rows in BD RAW DATA.xlsx against 157 in BD RAW DATA_3.xlsx.	Which file is current. Nothing can be migrated from two sources that differ, and neither file carries a version marker. See question F1.

13. NEXT STEPS

First, confirm the platform direction, because it determines how much of section 5 is configuration and how much is design. Second, hold the controlled-list workshop, which is useful regardless of platform and can happen immediately. Third, make the grain decision on the repeated client rows in the forecast sheet, since nothing can be migrated until that is settled. Everything else can proceed in parallel.

14. QUESTIONS FOR THE BD TEAM

This is a working checklist for the session with the team. The questions are grouped by topic and each one records what the answer actually changes, so that time can be spent on the ones that move the design rather than the ones that only affect wording. Anything not answered can be recorded as an assumption and revisited, with the exception of the five below.

Five questions block everything else: whether the amounts are commission or premium (C1), what Effective Month actually means (C2), which workbook is authoritative (F1), whether the repeated client rows are one deal or several (F2), and whether individual owners carry revenue targets (A1). Nothing can be migrated and no forecast can be trusted until these five are settled.

A. Team, ownership and access

#	Question	What the answer changes
A1	How many people are in BD today, and will each one carry an individual revenue target?	Whether Target needs an owner level at all. Today targets exist only per initiative, so the individual performance question cannot be answered.
A2	The 16 owner strings resolve to six people. Who are the six, and for records like Helen/Evelyn/Edgar, who is accountable and who is a co-owner?	Migration cannot assign ownership without this. It is a decision, not a data cleanup task.
A3	Who outside BD needs to see the pipeline, and should they see everything or only their own unit?	The permission model. Retrofitting row-level visibility into a custom build after launch is expensive.
A4	Should one owner be able to see another owner's opportunities?	Whether the default view is personal or shared. Affects how the forecast is assembled.
A5	Who may override a stage probability, and who approves a target once set?	Which fields need an approval step rather than just an audit entry.

B. Pipeline and stages

#	Question	What the answer changes
B1	Do the six stages in section 6 match how the team actually works, particularly for tenders?	The stage list itself. A tender may need its own path rather than sharing one with direct quotations.
B2	Roughly what proportion of pursuits are won?	Whether the default probabilities are realistic. They are currently inferred from the sheet, not from outcomes.
B3	39 of 187 rows are marked Lost with no reason recorded. What are the real reasons deals are lost?	The loss reason picklist, and the whole win and loss analysis report.
B4	Must an opportunity move one stage at a time, or can it skip?	Whether stage movement is validated. Affects the ageing and movement reports.
B5	At what point does BD hand over to operations, and should the CRM record that handover?	Whether the model needs a post-win state, or genuinely stops at won as section 1 assumes.

C. Revenue and money

#	Question	What the answer changes
C1	Is Expected Revenue Amount brokerage commission, or gross written premium?	Everything. If it is premium, the model needs a premium amount, a commission rate and a derived commission, and every figure in the current forecast changes meaning.

#	Question	What the answer changes
C2	Does Effective Month mean the month the cover incepts, the month revenue is recognised, or the month payment is expected?	How the whole forecast is phased. These three answers produce three different monthly forecasts from identical data.
C3	When a deal is won, is the actual amount recorded, or is the expected amount treated as final?	Whether forecast accuracy can ever be measured. Without an actual there is nothing to compare the forecast against.
C4	Will anything ever be transacted in a currency other than UGX?	Whether currency is needed on day one or can wait. Adding it later means restating history.
C5	Is revenue ever shared between two owners or two units?	Whether a schedule line needs a split allocation, which is structural rather than cosmetic.

D. Targets and budget

#	Question	What the answer changes
D1	What is the financial year end?	Every period boundary, target window and snapshot date in the system.
D2	Are targets set top-down from company level, or built up from owners?	Whether the system enforces that unit targets reconcile to the company target, or merely reports the variance.
D3	Is the BD cost budget in phase one, and does BD control it or does finance?	Whether sections 8.2 and the Budget Line entity are built now or deferred.
D4	Does finance already have cost categories we should reuse?	Whether the categories in section 8.2 are adopted as drafted or replaced with the existing chart of accounts.
D5	Are targets revised mid-year, and if so is the original target kept?	Whether Target needs versioning. Without it, performance against the original commitment is lost.

E. Strategic initiatives

#	Question	What the answer changes
E1	Can one opportunity contribute to more than one initiative?	Whether the link is one-to-many or many-to-many. This is a structural decision and hard to change later.
E2	Are initiatives fixed at the start of the year, or added during it?	Whether initiatives need their own lifecycle and start date, or are simply reference data.
E3	What does the August Commitment column mean, and is it still needed?	Whether it becomes a field, a snapshot, or is retired at migration.
E4	The initiative register differs between the two workbooks, 172 rows against 157. Which is right?	Which register is loaded. The difference has to be reconciled line by line before migration.
E5	Does an initiative have a target that is separate from the sum of its opportunities?	Whether initiative target is entered or derived. Section 5.4 currently assumes entered.

F. Data and migration

#	Question	What the answer changes
F1	Which workbook is authoritative, BD RAW DATA.xlsx or BD RAW DATA_3.xlsx?	The migration source. Nothing can be loaded from two files that disagree.
F2	Are the four Memnon Capital rows one deal or four, and are the monthly Credit Life rows one deal or several?	The opportunity grain. This is the one migration decision nobody outside the team can make.
F3	Can someone sign off the final product list, collapsing 24 values to roughly 16?	Every product-based report, and whether Medical, MED and Med are one thing or three.
F4	Are the UBA bancassurance rows ordinary opportunities, or structurally different?	Whether the model needs a partner or channel concept beyond the initiative link.
F5	How far back should we migrate: open pipeline only, or won and lost history too?	Whether win rate and loss analysis work from day one or start accumulating from launch.
F6	Are there other BD spreadsheets in use that we have not seen?	Whether the model is complete. Two versions of one file surfaced already.

G. Reporting and cadence

#	Question	What the answer changes
G1	What is reported to whom and how often, and is any of it reported outside Minet Uganda?	The report list in section 9, and whether group reporting imposes a format we do not control.
G2	Which report currently takes the longest to produce by hand?	Where the build should start. That report is the fastest visible return on the project.
G3	Is the forecast presented as a single number, or as a range?	Whether committed, weighted and best case are all needed, or only one of them.
G4	Is the monthly pack assembled in Excel or PowerPoint today, and does that need to continue?	Whether the system needs an export that matches an existing deck format.

H. The build itself

#	Question	What the answer changes
H1	Who administers the system after launch, including the picklists?	Whether list management needs an admin interface, or values are changed in the databases.
H2	Does this need to work on a phone in the field, or is desktop enough?	Scope and cost of the front end. Substantial either way, and hard to add afterwards.
H3	Does it need to connect to email, the policy administration system, or finance?	Whether integration is in phase one. Each connection is a project in its own right.
H4	What is the go-live date, and is it driven by anything external such as the planning cycle?	Whether phase one is the full model or a subset, and which sections get deferred.
H5	Is there an existing internal standard for authentication and hosting we must follow?	Whether identity and access are inherited or built. Usually inherited, and cheaper that way.

15. HOW BD REPORTS TODAY

The CEO Summit pack for September 2026 is the clearest available statement of what BD is accountable for, and it is a more demanding specification than the spreadsheets are. It runs to 36 slides covering the company position, five sectors, three units, a bancassurance partner, a tender engine, the strategic initiatives and a year-end landing. Reading it against the data model above produces one uncomfortable conclusion and several useful corrections.

The uncomfortable conclusion first. The pack reports revenue in three lines: New Business, Retention and Policy Fees, against a full-year budget of UGX 15,556m. New Business is UGX 3,191m of that, roughly a fifth. Retention is UGX 11,416m, roughly three quarters. Everything in the workbooks, and therefore everything in sections 4 to 9 of this document, covers New Business only. Section 1 puts retention and client servicing out of scope, which is defensible for a pipeline tool and indefensible if the CRM is expected to produce this pack. That contradiction has to be resolved deliberately rather than discovered during the build.

The pack also contains no native tables and no native charts. Across 36 slides there are 2,859 individual text boxes and 619 drawn shapes, and not one chart object with a data series behind it. Every figure, every column heading and every bar is typed or drawn by hand. That is the true cost of the current arrangement, and it is a stronger argument for the build than anything in section 3.

The measures the pack actually reports

Every sector and unit slide repeats the same measure set. None of these are exotic, but only two of them can be produced from the workbooks as they stand. The rest are being assembled by hand each month.

Measure	As reported	Available from the workbooks today
YTD actual	Revenue recognised to 31 August, by revenue line and sector.	No. The forecast sheet holds expectations, not actuals.
Outstanding proforma	Invoiced or committed but not yet recognised. Reported separately, then added to actual.	No. There is no such state in the model. It sits between won and collected.

Measure	As reported	Available from the workbooks today
Actual plus proforma	The basis the pack leads with.	No. Derived from the two above.
YTD budget	Budget phased to the month, not the annual figure divided evenly. January carries 28.9% of the year.	No. The register holds an annual target only.
Achievement and variance	Percentage of YTD budget and absolute gap, per line and per sector.	No. Requires actuals and a phased budget.
Prior year comparative	2025 YTD by line and sector, with year-on-year percentage.	No. Requires won history to be migrated.
Gross and weighted pipeline	Expected amount and expected multiplied by probability, by month.	Yes. This is the one thing the sheets do well.
Count above threshold	Number and value of opportunities at 50% and above, by month and sector.	Partly. Derivable but recalculated by hand each cycle.
Full-year landing	YTD actual plus proforma, plus September to December expected.	No. A distinct forecast view, not in section 7 as drafted.
Gap decomposition	Shortfall split by revenue line and by sector, each as a share of the company gap.	No. Requires budget and actual side by side.

Corrections to the model above

Six things in the pack contradict or extend what sections 4 to 9 assume. These are corrections rather than additions, and each one is cheaper to make now than after the schema is built.

What the pack shows	What section 4 to 9 assumed	The correction
Unit 1 is EMT and IND, Unit 2 is SPE and SME, Unit 3 is EBM. The workbook's Dept is the pack's Sector.	Unit, department and sector as three independent picklists on the opportunity.	One fixed hierarchy: unit contains sectors, and sector is the same field the workbook calls Dept. Retire department as a separate concept or define how it differs.
The register, the recovery path and every sector slide cut the pipeline at 50% and above.	A committed view defined as 85% and above.	50% is the house threshold. Make the threshold a configurable parameter and default it to 50%, and keep the band structure since the pack also reports at exactly 50% separately.
Three landing bases are shown side by side: committed, full weighted pipeline, and a repeat of last year.	Committed, weighted and best case.	Replace best case with the prior-year repeat, which is the comparison management actually uses, and add expected year-end landing as a named view.
Budget is phased to the month. 78.7% of the full-year budget falls in January to August.	Target held by year, unit, owner, initiative and product.	Target must carry a monthly phasing. Without it neither achievement nor the Sep-Dec versus phased-budget comparison can be produced.
Separate slides for MRS-supported opportunities in EMT and EBM.	A single CEO or management support flag.	Support is a typed intervention, not one flag. At minimum distinguish management support from MRS support, and record who was asked and when.
A tender tracker of 41 items with its own lifecycle, sitting outside the forecast.	Tenders as one stage value inside the opportunity pipeline.	A tender is a separate object with its own states, linked to an opportunity where one exists. See below.

The tender register, a thirteenth entity

The tender engine is tracked in two registers, 15 prequalifications and 26 tenders, and neither appears in the workbooks reviewed. It has its own lifecycle, its own win rate, and a value that is explicitly not revenue. The pack is candid about this: one register is headed Tender and Income, the other Tender and Sum Insured Value, and a

single line recorded at UGX 1.5bn cannot be brokerage income because it exceeds an entire sector's full-year budget. A value field with two incompatible meanings and no column to say which is the same category of problem as everything in section 3.

Tender therefore needs to be its own object rather than a stage on the opportunity. A prequalification precedes a tender, a tender may or may not produce an opportunity, and only three tender names appear anywhere in the September to December pipeline, so the two are genuinely separate populations.

Field	Type	Notes and validation
Tender ID	Auto number	System generated.
Type	Picklist, required	Prequalification or tender. The two are reported separately and have different success measures.
Issuing body and title	Text, required	The procuring entity and the tender reference.
Sector and unit	Picklist, required	Same hierarchy as the opportunity.
Recorded value	Currency, required	The figure as published.
Value basis	Picklist, required	Brokerage income, sum insured, or premium. This field is the fix for the current ambiguity. Values on different bases must never be summed.
Status	Picklist, required	To submit, submitted, in evaluation, prequalified, won, lost, withdrawn. Reported as decided against live.
Key dates	Dates	Published, submission deadline, submitted, decision. Deadline drives the only genuinely time-critical alert in the system.
Outcome and reason	Picklist plus text	Required once decided. The pack reports a 41.2% win rate by count against 17.1% by value, and cannot explain the difference without reasons.
Linked opportunity	Opportunity link	Set when a tender produces a forecastable pursuit. Optional, because most do not.
Parent prequalification	Tender link	Links a tender to the prequalification that enabled it, which is the conversion the pack says is not currently visible.

What the pack reveals about the underlying data

The pack is well argued and internally honest, and in the course of being honest it documents the state of the data better than any audit could. The items below are quoted from the pack itself and are the strongest available justification for the build.

Observation in the pack	What it means for the CRM
40 of 119 live opportunities have no owner recorded, carrying UGX 686m of gross pipeline that, in the pack's own words, cannot be managed to a close as recorded.	Owner must be mandatory at save, not a field to be completed later. This alone justifies validation at the point of entry.
7 of the 17 committed opportunities, UGX 760m, sit with a single owner, and the top eight owners hold 91%.	Concentration by owner is a standing report, not an observation someone happens to make. It is also an argument for owner-level targets.
93 of 119 live opportunities are below 50%.	The stage ladder and its exit criteria matter more than the probability field. Most of the book is sitting where movement is unverified.
October carries 32 opportunities and UGX 734m gross with nothing above 50%.	Phasing by month must be visible continuously, not discovered when the pack is assembled. This is a dashboard, not a slide.
The count of opportunities above 50% is given as 17 on two slides and, on the register, as 27 of 35 at 50% and above, with the value shown as UGX 965m in one place and UGX 804m in another.	The two figures may be on different bases, gross against weighted, but nothing on the page says so. A single definition held once, and a measure derived rather than typed, removes the question entirely.
The prequalification hit rate is 77.8% but conversion into submitted tenders is, in the pack's words, not visible.	The link between prequalification and tender has to be a relationship. The pack cannot report what the register does not join.

Observation in the pack	What it means for the CRM
Values in the tender registers are on two different bases and are not treated as revenue anywhere in the deck.	A value basis field, as specified above. The pack has to caveat every tender number because the data cannot.

I. Questions the pack adds to section 14

These belong in the same session. The first is now the largest open question in the project, ahead of the five listed in section 14.

#	Question	What the answer changes
I1	Is the CRM expected to produce this pack, or only the New Business pipeline part of it?	The scope of the whole project. Producing the pack means holding retention and policy fee revenue, actuals, proformas and a phased budget, which is a materially larger system than sections 4 to 9 describe.
I2	Where do YTD actual and outstanding proforma come from today, and could the CRM read them rather than hold them?	Whether the CRM needs an integration to finance or a manual monthly load. Either is acceptable; guessing is not.
I3	What exactly is a proforma, and at what point does it become actual revenue?	Whether it is a state on the opportunity, a state on the schedule line, or a separate record.
I4	Is Retention managed as a pipeline with owners and probabilities, or simply as a budget line that is measured?	Whether retention needs opportunities at all, or only a target and an actual.
I5	Who maintains the tender registers, and are they the same people who own opportunities?	Whether tender is a BD-owned object in the same system or a feed from elsewhere.
I6	What is MRS, and how does MRS support differ from CEO or management support?	Whether support is one flag with a type, or two separate concepts with different workflows.
I7	Do the unit groupings ever change, and can a sector belong to two units?	Whether unit is a fixed attribute of sector or a reporting rollup that varies by period.
I8	Should the system generate this pack directly, or feed a deck that is still assembled by hand?	Whether the build includes an export or reporting layer sized to replace 36 slides, which is a significant part of the estimate.

16. TEAM WORKLOAD AND CAPACITY

The system also has to answer whether the work is distributed sensibly: whether one person is carrying the initiatives, the tenders and the large pursuits while capacity sits idle elsewhere. Nothing in the workbooks can answer this. Ownership exists as a name typed into a cell, and there is no record of how much anyone is holding, how long they have held it, or whether it is moving.

Counting pursuits per person does not answer it either, and the September register shows why. One owner holds three pursuits worth UGX 420m gross. Another holds eight worth roughly UGX 12m. By count the second person is more than twice as busy. By value the first carries thirty-five times as much. Neither number is wrong and neither is useful alone, which is the same failure the pack runs into when it reports a tender win rate of 41.2% by count against 17.1% by value.

Being bogged down is a flow problem, not a stock problem. A large book that keeps moving is a productive person. The same book standing still is a bottleneck, and the difference between the two is only visible if the system records when each pursuit changed stage. That single requirement is the reason this section exists, and it cannot be reconstructed later: if stage movement is not captured from day one, the first year of the system can never be analysed for capacity.

What bogged down means in data

Ten signals, taken together. The first three are stock, the next three are flow, and the last four separate a person's own capacity from problems that belong to somebody else. No single one of these should trigger a decision on its own.

Signal	How it is measured	What it tells you
Open pursuit count	Open opportunities where the person is the accountable owner.	Raw stock. Misleading alone, as the register above shows, but it is the number everyone asks for first.
Weighted value held	Sum of weighted amounts across open pursuits.	Commercial load. The pack already shows 7 of 17 committed opportunities, UGX 760m, sitting with one owner.
Effort-weighted load	Open pursuits multiplied by a complexity weight, summed.	The only count that treats a tender and a small motor renewal as different amounts of work.
Initiatives championed	Initiatives where the person is champion, and the revenue gap those initiatives carry.	The load this question was actually about. Initiative work consumes time and appears nowhere in the pipeline.
Median days in stage	Age of each open pursuit in its current stage, aggregated by owner.	Distinguishes busy from stuck. A rising median is the earliest reliable signal of overload.
Stage advances per month	Forward stage movements per owner per month.	Throughput. Read against the stock measures, this is what separates a productive large book from a stalled one.
Actions overdue	Open next actions and initiative milestones past their date, plus those due in 30 days.	Overdue items accumulate before anything else visibly slips. The most actionable of the ten.
Accounts touched	Distinct clients across open pursuits.	Context switching. Twelve small clients cost more attention than three large ones of the same total value.
Blocked pursuits	Open pursuits with a blocker recorded, or support requested and not yet given.	Being blocked is not being overloaded, and the remedy is different. Separating the two prevents the wrong intervention.
Unowned work	Open pursuits with no accountable owner.	The pack records 40 of these carrying UGX 686m. Any capacity conversation has to start by assigning them.

What has to be recorded to make this possible

Seven additions. The first is a new entity and the most important thing in this section, because it is the only one that cannot be added retrospectively.

Addition	Where it sits	Why it is needed
Stage history	New entity, the fourteenth	One row per stage change: opportunity, stage from, stage to, changed by, changed at. Every flow measure above depends on it, and history that was never written cannot be recovered. Write it automatically, never by hand.
Complexity weight	Opportunity	Light, standard or complex, defaulted from product and pursuit type and overridable with a reason. Without it, effort-weighted load cannot be calculated and count-based load will keep pointing at the wrong person.
Accountable owner, single	Opportunity, already in 5.2	Restated here because load cannot be attributed to a cell reading Helen, Evelyn and Edgar. One accountable owner, co-owners recorded separately and excluded from the load calculation.
Champion and effort share	Strategic initiative	A champion, optional co-champions, and an indication of how much of the champion's time the initiative is expected to take. Initiative load is invisible today.
Action completion date	Next action, and initiative milestone	An action with no completion date cannot be told apart from one that is overdue. This is a one-field change that makes the overdue measure possible.

Addition	Where it sits	Why it is needed
Capacity reference	User	A nominal number of concurrent pursuits and an indicative split between pipeline work and initiative work. Crude, and still better than comparing everyone to the team average.
Availability	User, optional	Leave and part-time allocation. A person at 60% availability holding an average book is at full load, and the dashboard will say they are fine unless it knows.

The reports this produces

Report	What it shows and who uses it
Owner workload summary	One row per person across all ten signals, with the team median beside each. The standing view for a unit head.
Rebalancing view	Owners ranked by effort-weighted load against capacity, and for the most loaded, the specific pursuits that could move and who has room. Designed to end in a decision, not an observation.
Bogged-down exceptions	Owners whose median days in stage is rising while stage advances per month fall. This is the report that answers the question as asked, and it needs three months of stage history before it says anything.
Concentration alert	Share of committed value held by the single largest owner, with a threshold. On the current book this fires immediately at 79%.
Initiative load	Champions ranked by initiative count and by the revenue gap they carry, against their pipeline load. Shows whether initiative work is being absorbed by people who are already full.
Unowned queue	Open pursuits with no owner, by value and month. Worked to zero, then kept there by the validation rule in section 6.

One caution, and the questions it raises

These measures are for rebalancing work, not for ranking people, and the difference matters more than it sounds. If the team believes load metrics feed appraisal, the predictable response is to avoid taking ownership of difficult pursuits, and the system will have made the distribution worse while reporting that it improved. Two design choices reduce that risk: state the purpose openly when the dashboard is introduced, and restrict who can see individual load to the person themselves and their unit head.

The same caution applies to the complexity weight. It is a judgement, and if owners set it themselves it will drift upward. Default it from product and pursuit type, allow an override, and record who overrode it.

J. Workload and capacity

#	Question	What the answer changes
J1	Is the purpose of this rebalancing work, measuring individual performance, or both?	Whether load appears on an individual's own dashboard, in a manager view only, or in appraisal. It also determines whether the numbers will be trusted.
J2	Who decides that a pursuit moves from one owner to another, and does the CRM need to record the reassignment and its reason?	Whether reassignment is an audited event with history, or simply an edit to the owner field.
J3	Is initiative championing part of someone's job description, or additional to a full pipeline load?	Whether capacity is expressed as one number or split between pipeline and initiative work.
J4	What does a reasonable book look like: roughly how many active pursuits should one person carry?	The capacity baseline. Without a figure from the team the dashboard can only compare people to each other, which hides the case where everyone is overloaded.
J5	Should the six real people be able to see each other's load?	The visibility rule. In a team of six, anonymised comparison is not possible, so this has to be decided rather than assumed.

#	Question	What the answer changes
J6	Are there roles that carry pursuits but are not BD owners, for example a unit head who closes deals personally?	Whether capacity applies to everyone with pursuits or only to a defined BD role.

What only works once time has passed

Several of the measures in this document describe change over time, and change over time cannot be reported on the day a system opens. This is worth stating explicitly, because a dashboard that shows zero where it should show a trend looks like a defect and invites the conclusion that the build has failed. It has not. It is simply too new to have anything to say.

The distinction is between stock and flow. Stock measures read the current state of the book and work immediately. Flow measures compare one moment with another and need at least two moments to exist.

Measure or report	What has to accumulate first	Usable from
Stock load measures	Nothing. Pursuit count, value held, effort-weighted load, initiatives championed, accounts touched, unowned work and concentration are all computed from the current state of the book.	Day one.
Actions overdue	Next action dates being genuinely maintained, rather than left blank or set to TBA as they are in the sheets today.	About one month of real use.
Median days in stage	Stage history rows. Approximate from a backfilled entry date, exact only for pursuits that have changed stage inside the system.	Approximate at day one, dependable at about six weeks.
Stage advances per month	One complete calendar month of stage history.	Month two.
Bogged-down exceptions	Three months of stage history. The report compares a trend in ageing against a trend in throughput, so it needs a trend in both.	Month four.
Forecast movement report, section 7	Two monthly snapshots to difference, and four before the direction means anything.	Month two for the first comparison, month five for a trend.
Win rate and stage conversion	Outcomes recorded after go-live, unless won and lost history is migrated under question F5.	Immediately if history is migrated, otherwise two to three quarters.
Prior-year comparatives	2025 actuals loaded as history. These cannot be derived from the forecast sheets, which hold expectations only.	Only if the historical load is in scope.
Forecast accuracy	Won deals carrying an actual amount, set against the expectation that preceded them.	One quarter after go-live at the earliest.
Prequalification to tender conversion	A full procurement cycle passing through the register.	Six to twelve months, given how slowly tender decisions land.

Three things follow from this table, and all three are cheaper to decide now than to argue about after launch.

Backfill an approximate stage entry date at migration. The forecast sheet carries a Last Update Date on most rows. Loading it as the stage entry date gives ageing something to work with on day one instead of nothing. It is an approximation and has to be labelled as one: flag every backfilled row so it can be excluded from throughput, which it would otherwise distort by implying a stage change that never happened.

Show insufficient data, never zero. Any report that is not yet ready should say so on its face, with the date it becomes meaningful. A blank chart reads as a bug and a zero reads as a finding. Neither is true, and both cost credibility in the first month, which is exactly when the team is deciding whether to trust the system.

Keep the trend reports out of the phase one acceptance criteria. The build cannot be tested against a report that is structurally incapable of producing output yet. Test that stage history is being written correctly and that the calculation is right on seeded data, then accept the reports themselves at the month four review. This also protects the project from the opposite failure, which is quietly dropping stage history during a scope squeeze because nothing visible depends on it at launch.

None of this changes the design. It changes what should be expected of it in the first quarter, and it makes the case for capturing stage history from the first day rather than adding it once someone asks why the capacity report is empty.